

**Edwards Air Force Base
(Date Unknown)**

**Code: P = Voices of various Pilots A = Voices of various ATCs O = Voices of various Officers
H: Height coverage officer Pedro - San Pedro station**

SIDE A:

P: Alright, this is Jack.

A: Good. Hello, Jack.

.....
P: [fades in] Recording from the air.....matter of fact, this was the first one I observed and I would say now it's 20,000 feet.

A: Uh-huh. Huh.

A: I don't see anything in that area now.

A: No, I don't...we're not painting anything in that area.

P: Well, they have, well, I have 20,000 feet by eyeball. Could be 100,000.

A: Uh-huh. Right. Yeah.

A: Do you get anything between Victorville and Edwards?

P: Here's one out here.

A: Does it appear now that they are moving away and moving out?

P: [too faint to copy]

A: They're going, huh?

P: I alreadyofficer... I don't think got here in time to see 'em. They're going up.

A: Hmm. Does it look like they are moving away and moving out?

P: Yes, it sure does. They're goin'. They're goin. The ones to the south, they're going straight up. All of them are.

A: Hmm. About how many were there?

P: At one time I had seven.

A: Uh huh.

P: At the present time I have 1-2-3-4-5 rising too.

A: Are those five also rising?

P: All five of 'em are rising

A: Alright.

P: At one time I had....

A: [cuts in].....go up to the roof and take a look.

A: Okay, run up.

P: ...did you ever see anything, __ One?

O: This is Captain Clark. I can't seem to find anything but stars out there.

P: Well, sir, they are all rising now.

O: (Clark) Is that right?

P: Yes sir. They're all going up now.

O: (Clark) Okay, you've got one bright star just about south of us. Where from that? You know, that bright one - I think it's about a 45 degree angle up.

P: Uh.

A: AFL?

A: Yeah.

A: Maintenance control.

A: Yeah.

O: Let us - get back to me. We're just in the process of winding this thing up, OK?

A: Okay.

P: All of 'em now appear that their red light has stopped.

O: I didn't see any red light.

P: All of them from here now, that the red light has stopped and they all appear to be heading ____

O: Is that right?

A: I'm gonna watch that bright one again.

O: Okay

[Voices in background are relating what pilot says through a radio or phone, talking to other parties.]

P: There's 3-4 of them, well south and dim.

O: Okay.

P: I still red light occasionally out of one of them.

O: Where are they from that big bright one?

P: Beneath them and just a little bit south. And there's three of 'em almost in a straight line.

O: Uh huh.

P: Almost horizontal.

O: I see.

P: And I still see a red light occasionally from those, but not from the big one.

O: Yeah. Okay. When you come down take a look at 'em again.

P: Okay sir. ____, you still on?

A: Roger.

P: Yeah, they all appear to be leaving now. I don't know.

A: Okay. Too bad we didn't get up on 'em.

P: I don't know, it was definitely...

A: [cuts him off] No. No, I'll call ya when....

P: This space - this space officer that has been observing this here with me all night. Here, let me get him back on and see if he is getting the same impressions of it I'm getting. I don't like to be the only one seeing these type things.

A: Roger. [laughs]

[delay]

A: Base Ops....

O: [on plane?] Yessir. Let's register this along with you.

A: Right.

O: The man says the tower boy there is froze. He has had somebody confirm his story. He says they are all pulling up at a very rapid rate right now.

A: Well, we'll wait and go. All we need is their request.

O: Alright sir.

A: We've lost radar contact with them.

O: How long ago did you lose radar with them?

A: Oh, I'd say roughly 10-15 minutes.

O: ____ is on the other phone. I might get a consultation to see if he's seeing the same thing I'm... it appears to me that they are all rising in altitude rapidly. It would appear to be. Yep. How about the bright up? Does it appear to be straight up? How about straight - that's much higher now than when we first saw it. Yeah.

O: (different voice) Call the Navy if you can. Ask if they have any balloon launches out of Ontario?

O: Len?

O: Roger.

O: It's (a name - can't make out) again. Base Ops confirms my - what I'm seeing. They are all rising and the weatherman in Base Ops has been observing these things all night with me and he has been using reference points to try to judge if they're moving.

O: Right.

O: And he confirms that they are very much higher now than what they were. They are, they are definitely going up.

O: Do you have any estimate on the altitude now?

O: I'd hate to venture a guess. I would say something like maybe 30,000-40,000, but now this is strictly way outoff the eyeball guess.

O: Not on my low altitude ?

O: No sir, I wouldn't say. Not nearly what they were. At first sighting on that one, I would have judged it's altitude to be no more than, at the most, 5,000 feet.

O: Well, we had some measured altitudes but, but said UFO officer was gonna want us to take a look. We were waiting to go. But I haven't heard anything yet from him.

O: I don't think he's made it to Base Ops yet.

O: Well, I told Sgt. Horner to ask him why he was and tried to get a decision then, but I haven't heard anything.

O: Well, I wanted this captain down here at ____ to see it before we went or something. I can't make out any red lights anymore.. (two voices talking at once). One is still definitely flickering. Well, they're all still flickering but they are so far away now I can't make out the red light. It was like there was just a small red light on the bottom of it like an obstruction light of some type.

O: Did anybody talk to the Navy down at Miramar, Ontario - in that area to see if they launched anything?

O: No sir, I haven't talked to anybody. All I've talked to are all the people here. Tower operator at George.

O: We'll see if we can get a hold of them down there. I think we can get a line we can get a line to them, they might know...

O: I don't have any interest in communications with them.

Q: Hey, Sarge?

O: Yes sir?

Q: Has the captain come back yet? To the Squadron?

O: No sir, he didn't come back on the line yet. [mangled]

O: Once I got a look at that real bright object, it looked like....[breaking up]

O: I see? He found it?

O: Yeah, he found the bright object the first time and he thought it was a star and it was coming in that this was a star but he had seen the (?) again but he'll take another look at it and we'll see if he can find the other thing that....

O: At one time I had seven of 'em.

O: I see, how many have you got now?

O: (on plane) I have five of 'em now.

O: Still have five?

O: Yep. Well, now, since I, since that first rack of the fence they seem to be stationary again now.

O: I see. How many degrees off the horizon would you say?

O: Oh, good grief, there's the...

O: A 45 degree angle?

O: At least. Or more.

O: 60?

O: 45 at least...about 45-50 degree angle. That's the brightest one. The other ones would be in the lesser angle. Maybe 30 degrees angle but they're much further away.

O: Did you see anything when you went out?

O: (new) No, I didn't see anything.

O: Oh. I didn't either.

O: Couldn't see for the haze anyway. We can't even see the lights on top the mountain.

O: Yeah.

A: You know, we have a lot of traffic. Well, not a lot of traffic but we have some traffic moving in that area now. I was wondering maybe if they might have gotten up out of the way or something. This whole thing is nice, isn't it?

A: Yeah, it was {slurred}

A: Yeah, sure does.

O: (on plane) Those to the south are really giving a blinking now.

O: What are they doing?

O/P: Blinking.

O: Hmmmm. How big an object would you say they were?

A: That'd be hard to say.

O/P: {laughs} It's very hard to say. From the distance, from what I have judged to be the distance and the altitude of these things..

O: Uh-huh.

O/P:the closest one to me has the, about the area of two stars. About twice as big as a normal star and very bright.

O: This is Captain Clark back on again.

O: Yes, Captain Clark! What did you find out out there?

CC: On that bright star now, let's see if I have the right one, coming down and to the right slightly you find three that are in kind of a "V".

O: That's the ones you're looking at?

A: Yes sir.

CC: And then I see one on the bottom bar of that V, the V kind of aims up to the right.

A: Yes sir.

CC: Between the two bottom stars, and I see one that does seem to be twinkling red.

A: Yes sir. That one in the center now appears to be the one that's doing it.

CC: Yeah.

A: More than the other one. Earlier the big bright one was blinking. He has quit now.

CC: Yeah.

A: The three to the south...they seem to be..one of them will blink and then it will be the other one and then another one.

CC: I see.

A: But I can't get all three of them to blink, to blink red, at any one time.

CC: They sure look like they're a long ways.

A: Those three are. This one is very high. The bright one is very high now. When I first observed it, it didn't appear to be no more than 5,000 feet and about over the ____.

CC: Oh? For heaven's sakes. Well, it looks like it's well up there now.

A: Yes sir. I have made a guesstimate at 40,000.

CC: Yeah.

O: Who does?

A: I have - well of course, that's just my eyeball on it.

CC: Yeah.

O: Paul?

Paul: Yeah.

O: Okay. Our night finders are locked on them.

Paul: Oh, they are?

O: Boron (?) says they have them locked on.

O: What do, what do they say they are?

O: Stand by just a second.

O: Okay. What is the altitude on them? 11,000?

O: Well, I don't know whether the night finders are locked on or not. They're saying 8,000.

O: 8,000, huh?

O: Yal.

O: (another) What do you have for distance on them?

O: Standby.

A: I have to say more than 8 on this one I see.

O: Yeah, it looks like a real fine star. Does it show any perceptible movement?

A: Well sir, it has moved. That's the thing. It has moved.

O: Yeah. Well, I couldn't determine anything out there on the wall where I was standing.

A: Well, now. I have observed it now for an hour and 50 minutes.

O: Yeah.

A: Almost two hours now. And in that time it has gained altitude twice and moved what would appear to be five or six miles to the west.

O: Uh-huh.

O: (another) Does anybody have the winds over there?

A: Yes sir, I have it here in the tower. It's presently calm. No more than 2 knots and they are westerly winds. And these things are moving westerly.

O: Oh, hold it. I've got a report here from Lans. My airman says he's got one moving up there. He's taking my binoculars up now and take a look.

O: Okay, sir, stand by. I've got another phone ringing.

O: Okay, go ahead.

P: Hello, I'm drawing back to base, I'll be back shortly.

A: Okay, you got a range as (blurred, then delay).

A: Can you see them?

(delay)

O: Ask the _____ if he's got a height on any of them.

O: Okay, and so they're down on MDS..

O: It's down, it should be down.

O: Sgt. Duane? This is Lt. Masack. I'd like to break off here for a second if I could, please. We need the line.

O: Alright. Roger.

O: Okay, stand by One.

O: So they have moved around, huh?

P: Right, sir, they have moved and _____ indicated _____ the search and the height at the rate I set at the same time and we are....maintaining coverage on these aircraft - on these objects.

O: Okay. Stand by.

H: Pedro? Hello, Pedro.

Pedro: It's _____.

H: Right. You still got these guys on your search?

Pedro: Search?

H: Or on your height.

Pedro: Got some of 'em on my height here.

H: Okay. What _____ now, on the special you got?

Pedro: These are a _____.

H: Zero Three Zero to Zero Six Zero since we've been talking, observing him. Can you pick up on him? Okay, now here's the other one. I want to make sure he's _____.

(Lots of noise, horns, rings, beeps, etc. on tape)

A: Right. The only one I can see flashing.

O: Okay, sir. Here's height coverage from the site. Okay. _____ Major Strubble break through. The rest of you people on the line if you want to hear the Major speak.

A: The height people are on now.

H: Okay. The target has moved 3 miles to Zero Nine One. It's moved from Zero Three Zero degrees at 80 miles to Zero Six Zero at 30, at uh 50 _____ on the site.

O: Which site?

H: From San Pedro.

O: Okay, say that again. Range and azimuth from Pedro?

H: Range and azimuth from Pedro just moved from Zero Three Zero at 80 miles. First pick-up. And presently he is Zero Six Zero at uh, Pedro what did you say that range was? On that last request?

Pedro: I didn't give you the range.

H: Oh, you didn't?

O: Zero Six Zero at what range?

H: Give range on this one, please.

Pedro. Okay. The one I've presently got?

H: Let's see. Negative. Okay, Pedro, give azimuth and range.

O: Pedro, you on?

Pedro: Right, I have Six Zero on the line.

H: Okay, what was the range? We didn't get that. Okay, Pedro, give azimuth and range on this target now.

Pedro: Got it. Azimuth is Zero Seven Zero. Range is about - I can't pick him up.

H: What's range?

Pedro: I can't pick him up. Range is about 40 miles, I guess.

H: Okay. Got problems with the instrumentation. Aman (?) said, first position on this target was 20 miles.

END OF SIDE A, TAPE 1

SIDE B:

A: Yes sir?

O: Look around to about uh, look uh, about Two Two Zero, for 5 miles or so.

A: Two Two Zero?

O: Alpha Zero has a contact, he says about 15 right or 20.

A: Two Two Zero?

O: Right.

O: Alpha. Do we got any flights down there anywhere now?

A: No sir, we don't. We're gonna let them fly.

P: Begin Pedro.

A: There is a light out there over the base..

O: Right.

H: Not at 80 miles now.

Pedro: Oh he is?

A: If I could contact now.

H: Please give us the azimuth and range on it, Pedro.

Pedro: Now he's at Zero Zero Zero for about 16 miles.

O: Uh, that is Interceptor.

Pedro: Good. Thank you.

(delay - just background noise)

P: Tower?

A: Yes sir?

P: Okay, we're going to turn it to Zero One over the runway again.

A: Okay. Which runway are you setting her down?

P: Well, it's turning, it's kinda swinging too far out. We don't like that, so we're gonna come in from about your...

A: Why don't you let it come in _____.

P: We're gonna come in. We're about your Two Seven Zero position.

A: Two Seven Zero?

P: Right. Flying Zero Nine Zero, right over the top of you.

A: Are you gonna come east, uh west-east over me then?

P: Right.

A: Right. What did he find out there to the west?

P: He lost his contact.

A: I still have a contact out there.

P: Oh you do? Visual?

A: Yes.

P: Is it one of these objects? Does it look the same as the rest of them?

A: No. This one uh just appears to be a flashing. Nothing red or green at the bottom.

P: Oh, I see. Could be something else.

A: Turn steady at Three Four Zero.

H: Uh, Pedro?

Pedro: Roger.

H: What the azimuth on that request you just had?

Pedro: Again?

H: Give me an azimuth off of this request.

Pedro: Alright.

O: Hey, Lans?

H: Right.

O: Send us that again, I _____ provide a checklist.

H: Okay.

Pedro: Matt?

H: Rog.

Pedro: Okay, I have your azimuth. He's heading Zero Nine _____.

H: No, he's heading Three Four Zero now.

Pedro: Lans?

H: Right.

Pedro: 345. Range about 80.

H: Okay. That's Interceptor.

A: They're gonna swing him Zero Nine Zero again shortly here. Right over tower. Okay, turn it starboard Zero Nine Zero.

H: Pedro?

Pedro: Matt, are you getting any data off these objects now?

H: Pedro, hi.

Pedro: This is Pedro. How are ya doing?

H: Right. Kick your Number One into manual and follow the Interceptor and I'll tell you when to chase ahead of it.

Pedro: _____ degrees?

H: Right. He should be back to Three Five Zero degrees now. He's picking up his Zero Nine Zero heading.

Pedro: Okay _____. Okay.

P: Okay, Tower, we have Zero One now bearing about Two Nine Zero for 15.

A: _____. At 15?

P: Right. Coming straight for ya.

A: What heading? What heading are they on?

P: It's heading Zero Nine Zero.

A: Zero Nine?

O: What frequency is he on?

O: I think he's heading on a One One Zero.

H: Pedro, you locked on Interceptor now?

Pedro: Say again, Lans?

H: Are you locked on Interceptor now? Are you locked onto the Interceptor with your height finder?

Pedro: I can't hear you.

H: Say, have you got your height finder on the Interceptor.

Pedro: I'm not sure yet. How many degrees again?

H: Three Six Zero.

Pedro: Three Six Zero? What position and what range?

H: About 75.

H: Okay, we've been checking Zero One. They should be heading Zero Nine Zero right over your tower.

A: Zero Nine Zero overhead?

H: Yeah, he's about 6-8 miles out now from you.

A: Six or eight miles? What altitude?

H: 25,000.

O: And what altitude was he at last?

A: 25.

A: 25?

A: He was up to 25,000?

A: He's just - I'll point him to Zero One at 25,000.

A: 25?

A: Rog.

[background voices]

A: Okay. Zero One should be directly overhead now.

(delay)

O: How's Zero One looking now?

A: I don't have him in sight.

O: Oh, he's right overhead, I guess.

(delay)

A: Rog.

A: Alright, I have Alpha Lima in sight now.

A: Yeah, he says he's got a contact. 12 o'clock 16.

A: That's it.

H: Okay, Pedro. Turn your height finder 7 degrees ahead of him. Turn your height finder 7 degrees ahead of that height - ahead of that Interceptor.

O: That should be a contact.

H: Hey Tower?

A: Yes?

H: How's he looking now? Is he headed toward anything?

A: Pretty good. He looks good.

H: Are the blips merging..I mean, uh...

A: Yes, he's converging on him.

H: You got any contacts out there?

O: No contacts out here.

H: Okay, keep going..keep going ahead. Go as far as 25 to 15 degrees ahead of the target.

O: Hey, Tower _____

A: They are converging. He seems to be maybe just a little bit south of it. Left turn, left turn. Low left turn. He's low and left. That thing is rising.

H: Tower, how's things look now?

A: He's low! Search high - search high. Search very high, the thing is rising. It's rising rapidly.

O: It looks like it's right above him from the Tower now.

A: It looks almost directly above him and rising.

H: Okay. Pedro, come back. Come back to the 'Ceptor.

A: You're in the general vicinity now. It looks much higher, much higher.

H: Hmmm. You got the Interceptor back, Pedro? You got the Interceptor back on your height finder?

A: That thing is, that thing is 10 to 15,000 higher.

O: Ten to 15,000 higher.

A: He has gone past it.

H: He has gone too far forward?

A: He's gone too far forward. Have him do a 180 and come back. And much higher.

H: Okay. Pedro, you get that Interceptor now.

Pedro: Okay. Okay.

H: You got him? Pedro?

Pedro: Alright, just a minute. Okay, Tower reports an object about 15,000 foot higher. I'm not picking up anything now.

H: You're not picking up the Interceptor.

Pedro: I can see a long _____.

A: I've lost contact with Alpha Lima....

H: Yeah, he's flying...

A: But I have the object in sight. It's much higher than it was, though.

H: Okay. Alpha Lima's gonna climb to 40,000.

A: Okay.

H: Okay, Pedro. Turn your height finder to Zero Three Zero degrees.

A: Have Alpha Lima show a landing light.

Pedro: No contact at Zero Three Zero.

H: Hold Zero Three Zero. Search 15 degrees either side Zero Three Zero.

Pedro: Okay.

O: Okay, Tower. Turning Alpha Lima Zero One Port Two Five Zero should bring him straight in over the top of you.

A: Over the top of us again? Interceptor still holding Two Five thousand.

H: Right. He's climbing. He's climbing to 40,000. Pedro, he'll be climbing to 4,000. 40,000, I'm sorry.

A: Is he up from me now?

H: Pedro, search. Are you on here?

Pedro: Roger, go ahead.

H: Okay. Next time he gives me a position that he's passing this object, I'm gonna give it to you and right then I want you to mark it and have your height finder search 15 degrees either side of that.

Pedro: Okay.

O: Where's Alpha Lima now?

O: Hey, Tower?

A: Yes?

O: They didn't say what frequency the Alpha Lima was on, did they?

A: No. If I had to guess...

O: Two Three Zero might do it.

A: Lans?

H: Yes?

A: What frequency are you working Alpha Lima on?

H: Two Eighty Two Two.

A: Two Eighty Two Two?

H: Rog.

O: Okay, Alpha Lima Zero One should be closing on that object we just made a pass at. And a possible contact down our search radar.

A: Lans?

H: Rog.

A: Where's Alpha Lima now?

H: He's Zero Six Five for 30 from you now.

A: Zero Six Five 30.

H: Right. Make that 25 now.

A: 25.

H: Rog.

O: Mark that spot, Sherm. We lost the possible contact on search radar again.

A: What altitude?

H: Okay, Zero One now should be Zero Six Zero for 20.

A: Zero Six Zero for 20. What altitude?

H: 40,000.

A: 40?

H: Rog. Pedro, he's now at level 40. He's climbing at 40, he should be at 33 now. 34.

Pedro: 33, 34. Alright, sir.

H: You got him, Pedro?

Pedro: Zero Three Two. Got a target there. He's coming inbound.

A: You got any possibilities you can run him on?

H: Okay, Tower.

A: Yes.

H: We have Alpha Lima Zero One, Zero Eight Zero for 18.

A: Yeah, I think I have Alpha Lima now. One of the objects is to his right. It's low.

H: To his right and low.

A: Yeah.

H: (calls out) Search visually right and low. Pedro search? Mark that spot. Check 5 degrees either side of that search, height finder and look high and low. Okay, Zero One is at 40,000.

A: You got 40?

H: Yeah, he's searching right and low. No joy. Tower, how is he in reference to some of the blips now?

A: I'm not sure I have him now. I think I've lost him.

H: He is now about..uh..Alpha Lima is now about One Two Zero for 13.

A: One Two Zero at 13?

H: Rog. 40,000.

O: Yeah, he's really enjoying that area. Pedro, you guys find target out there?

Pedro: He is too far away. He's too far west.

O: Alpha One Zero is too far west?

Pedro: Yes.

O: Well, now he's only about - he's bearing about One Three Five for 8 from you now.

Pedro: I have him at about One Six Zero, moving almost due south of me now. He is well west of all the objects.

O: Roger, we'll bring him over your station again, head up that way.

Pedro: Okay, have him come right, have him line up with my runway Zero Four. Have him go in a right turn and roll out Zero Four Zero and bring him right down my runway.

H: You're gonna do what now?

Pedro: Right turn and roll out Zero Four Zero, come right down my runway.

H: Okay. Realize his turn radius up there is about 20 miles.

Pedro: That'll put him to the north when he comes around.

H: Rog. Okay.

Pedro: Okay. Put him in a starboard turn Zero Four Zero.

H: Zero One, turning starboard Zero Four Zero.

P: Roger.

H: That should bring him in quite a ways north of you.

Pedro: Yes he will. We'll probably lose him when he goes over the tower and have to catch him on the..

H: Rog.

Pedro: I'll try to keep an eye on him.

H: I've got a possible contact on search radar bearing from your station Zero Seven Five for 10.

Pedro: Zero Seven Five at 10?

H: Roger. Anything out there?

Pedro: I have one at Zero Seven Five, could _____.

H: Rog.

Pedro: And high. He's in our blanked out area now.

H: Which height finder?

[several speaking at once]

O: Lans, this is Tower.

H: Rog.

O: This is Captain Clark. Do you have any height on these things over here to the east of Edwards?

H: Negative. Unable to get them on height finder. We're trying to mark them now with the Interceptor passes under them.

CC: Right.

H: Or in the vicinity of them. And we are unable to get them on the height finder at the present time. If you give me an approximate time that he does pass under this, I got the surveillance man at the site standing by to mark this position. I'll have both height finders search that area.

CC: Okay.

A: Okay, he's looking pretty good.

H: Okay. Zero One's gonna come in about 2 or 3 miles north of your station.

A: I have him in sight.

H: He's in a right turn. And you have him steady on what heading?

A: If he comes directly across from Tower from his present position, he'll head right straight towards us. Have him, have him hold, when he comes over the Tower, have him hold that heading.

H: What heading?

A: The heading he'll be on when he comes over the Tower, he's heading right straight over the Tower now. Have him hold that heading.

H: He's steady on the steady out over the Tower.

A: Okay, steady out and head almost due...head him about Zero Eight Zero. He's overhead Tower now.

H: Pedro?

Pedro: Right, Pedro.

H: Right, you got this guy on your height finder right now?

Pedro: Not on height One Zero.

H: Got him on search.

Pedro. Negative. Don't have him on...he's in a blanked out area over here.

H: On your search he's blanked out?

Pedro: Negative. On the height finder.

H: Nah, have you got him on the search?

Pedro: Right, I got him.

H: Okay.

A: What heading is the Interceptor on now?

H: He's on Zero Eight Zero heading.

A: Okay, hold that.

P: Zero Zero Zero at 16, 72.

H: He should be directly overhead now. What's his nearest target at this time? Tower? Hey, Tower this is Lans.

A: Go ahead, Lans. This is Tower on.

H: Yeah, what's his nearest target at this time.

A: I can't even see him anymore now. He hasn't come out the east side of the Tower yet. How far east is he showing?

H: Two miles now. He's eight miles high.

A: I have him in sight now.

H: Okay, he's heading Zero Eight Zero.

A: Okay. Have him continue Zero Eight Zero. About Zero Seven Zero now.

H: Okay, he's past the Tower by 5 miles.

A: Zero, head him left Zero Seven Zero.

H: He's turning port Zero Seven Zero now.

A: Roger. I have him.

H: Rog. How's he lining up?

A: He looks pretty good.

H: Luminous object 12 o'clock?

A: Should be 12 o'clock.

?: (calls out) Luminous object 12 o'clock.

A: Have him turn port another 10 degrees. Port Zero Six Zero.

H: Zero Six Zero now.

A: He'll be passing to the right of it.

?: Passing slightly right.

A: Another port.

H: Port how much?

A: 20 degrees. And high, high. He's way low.

H: Way low?

A: Yes.

H: We're at 40,000 feet!

A: Still low. Search high. I would say he was about under it now.

?: He should be under it now.

H: Did he pass under target at this time?

A: Yes, about the time I said mark it appeared that he was almost under it.

H: Okay. Mark that spot there. Pedro?

Pedro: Right.

H: Okay, search 10 degrees either side. Hm. All Zero One reports is one great big bright shiny star.

A: That's what it appears like from the Tower now. It has that appearance from here now. It is much, much higher than when we first observed it.

H: If it's that much higher, we're not gonna see it on the search radar.

A: I suspect it's over your radar now. It's hard to judge the distance.

Pedro: Pedro.

H: Go.

A: Let me take a quick scan of the skies here and see what else, see if I can spot another one.

P: ...72.

H: Zero One Zero 72. Is that in the area of this target you're searching?

Pedro: Rog. This is the search. PPI.

H: That is the PPI search area?

Pedro: I have the Interceptor at another range now but I have another target. Zero One Zero headed east.

H: Hey, Tower?

A: Yes sir?

H: Have you got anything else in sight?

A: No sir, just those two that we tried on there. And he appeared from the Tower to pass way beneath it.

H: Edwards?

A: Yes sir?

H: Is there one about southeast of you, about 3 miles at this time.

A: He's at 3?

H: Right. Yes, southeast much closer. We've got a possible contact there on something.

A: Just a moment, I see something, let me throw my glasses on it.

H: One Two Zero.

A: Let me throw my glasses on it.

[background]

H: Pedro, what's the ground speed on that target you got?

Pedro: That I just gave you?

H: Right.

Pedro: I don't know, I scanned him twice and now he's gone.

H: Painted him twice and he's gone. That's what I was afraid of. Hey, Tower? Hey, Tower? Hmm. Sir, I hate to be an optimist but that fighter looks like he's going some place.

H: Pedro?

Pedro: Right.

H: Right. Did you find anything back in that search area I gave you?

Pedro: Negative.

H: Nothin'. Hey, Tower? They've all been kidnapped.

A: Lans?

H: Rog.

A: Just a minute here. (pause) The only one I have now that I can definitely say is making the colors is -

H: Stand by, Pedro.

A: ...is approximately One Two Zero from me.

H: One Two Zero from you?

A: Yes.

H: I've got a possible contact on search there.

A: What, sir?

H: Stand by, Tower. Let me tweak and see if there's any...I'm gonna leave the phone here for a second. Okay, Pedro.

Pedro: I just had a _____

[huge increase in background noise - continuous]

O: Where is Alpha Lima Zero One?

H: Zero One is bearing Zero Eight Five 30.

A: Still there?

H: Rog.

A: Uh - bearing of Zero One Zero?

H: Right.

A: He's about 16,000 feet?

H: 16,000?

A: Right. Sir? W.D.? Yo!

H: Rog. Right. That target at Edwards there is at 16,000.

O: You've got him on target at 16,000?

H: Right.

O: That's One Six thousand?

H: Right, 16,000. Pedro? Keep your height finder locked on it. And search. Keep an eye on it.

Pedro: Is that at uniform One Zero Six?

H: Negative. This is an uninitiated track. It's uh. _____ at Edwards.

Pedro: Roger. I see. We'll initiate it.

H: Keep an eye on it. Last time we did, it split. Remember?

O: You still got prism search?

H: Tower, come back on the air. Sir. Yes. That target has disappeared off of radar.

O: I've got some present data here now.

H: Yah I see it. No, that's not it. You hit the wrong one. It's the one above it. _____

O: I don't show anything else.

H: He's coming in head on at it.

O: Roger. Were you able to establish a track out of that?

H: Negative, Edwards was able to establish a track. Have you still got it on height finder. Hey, Tower?

A: Yes sir.

H: Zero One bearing One Two Zero for 10 coming now.

A: One Two Zero at 10. What altitude?

H: He's descending to One Five.

A: I don't have it.

H: Okay. Zero One's got a visual - a flashing target, low, his present position.

A: He's got one?

H: Yes he does.

A: Alright. Zero Zero Eight. He's in the right place.

H: He's in the right place now, huh?

A: I don't have him in sight but if he's Zero Ten at 10 he's in the right place.

H: Okay, there's a target at One south. Hey, Tower?

A: Yes sir.

H: You've got a visual on Zero One? He's about One Four Zero for 8 now. Now about One Six Zero.

A: Here he is. Okay. I have Alpha Lima. What's the heading of Alpha Lima?

H: Alpha Lima is now at 11,000 feet. He's bearing One Six Zero for 6 from you.

A: Yeah, what's the heading.

H: Let's see, he's orbiting now. Looks like he's turning starboard directly over ya.

A: Does he have a _____.

H: Hey, Edwards?

A: Yes?

H: Do you have Zero One now?

A: Yes, I have him tracked.

H: Is he still in the vicinity of the target?

A: I can't definitely say that that is a target. We saw it. We have what he's looking at but it doesn't appear to be ah, flashing from the Tower. I think we have what he's looking at. We do have something out there. I can't say what it is.

[terrible background noise continues]

H: But that's not a target, huh?

A: It doesn't look like the other ones did. It looks further away. It looks like he's coming back over the field now. He's heading out west of me now, right?

H: Say again?

A: He's out west of me now, right?

H: Roger.

O: Did the Interceptor make any contact with that target Zero One Zero?

H: He ran right over it. I don't think - I don't know if he made contact visual on it or not.

A: ...it's stationary....

H: Is he stationary?

A: Rog. 16,000?

A: 16,000 _____.

H: Weapons? W.D.? What happened to Weapons? Did they drop off? What happened to the fighter? Somebody ease him off?

A: He's right over Edwards.

H: Oh, he's right over you?

A: Right up overhead. You got him on the height finder?

E: He's not over Edwards now.

H: Does somebody have him on a height finder?

O: What about Pedro?

H: They're looking for him. They've got him on search. Weapons?

W: Rog.

H: Weapons on? We looked for ya there for a second.

W: Yeah, I dropped off for a second. Okay, Alpha Zero One is in approach, we can see him at this time.

H: Is he coming back for another pass on 109, sir? That's what we just put on that _____ pass.

O: Huh, 109, huh? What's the height on 109 there? Got a height on him?

H: Last time they had him he was at 16,000.

O: 16, huh?

H: Pedro?

Pedro: Roger?

H: You still got that bat on the radar?

Pedro: I still have him on search.....

?: Search One Zero Nine and see what you get.

H: You had him at 16,000 though, right?

Pedro: Right. He's stationary, he hasn't moved but about one degree. He's still the same.

H: Okay, put that height finder on automatic and I want to sent a request to it.

Pedro. Will do.

[roaring background noise continues]

O: _____?

H: Rog.

O: Look on visual. What does Alpha Lima come up with on visual?

P: Negative.

H: Negative. Okay, Pedro, you got the request.

Pedro: Okay. I haven't received it yet.

H: No, on Zero. One won't go up that high.

Pedro: Okay, I got it.

A: We've got radar contact out here at your One Three Zero position for 12.

H: Say again?

O: Are you running an ETM on it now?

H: Affirmative.

O: I don't have any contact on it now _____. Okay, does Zero One have a visual contact on these things?

A: Yes.

O: Okay, we'll cover off Lima Zero One then.

A: I don't have another one in sight.

H: You lost them all, huh? Zero One said he saw some reflections off the ground that appear to be flashing.

A: Reflections off the ground that appear to be flashing?

H: Right. Off the lake bed.

A: Huh. I don't know what that could be - my beacon?

H: No, he knows the beacon. Okay, Sir, might as well key off and break this line down then.

A: Okay, sir.

H: We'll see you tomorrow night.

O: Surveillance here. Do you want to debrief Alpha Lima?

H: Yeah, I've been looking at it in the air here on my - on the monitor.

O: Yeah. Are you going to debrief him when he lands?

H: Probably will.

O: Okay. I'll come over for that then.

H: Okay, fine.

O: Alright. Thank you.

[phone ringing]

FS: Flight supervisor.

H: ____ three. You wanted to know the results of Alpha Lima Zero One?

FS: Yeah.

H: Negative.

FS: Negative results, huh?

H: Well, he picked up a low-flying aircraft, a few ground targets, things like that.

FS: I'll be doggone.

H: He went through it 15, 25 and 40,000 feet on these visual objects and uh, supposedly flew right under it according to ground observations, visual observations, and I recorded nothing flying underneath it.

FS: Okay, well thanks very much. It was kind of interesting anyway.

H: Yeah, it is. We're as curious as you are.

FS: Yeah.

H: Guess we'll never know.

FS: Yeah. I guess not. Okay, well, thanks for calling.

H: Rog.

[phone ringing]

SG: _____ Snyder George(?).

H: Right. This is _____ W.D. Tech One. T-More(?) will be active this morning.

SG: Okay, sure, kiddo.

H: Tell the boss.

[phone ringing]

?: _____

H: Right. Is Jack — oh, good. Good morning, Jack. This morning _____.

[Ends and different voices pick up.]

[faint voice] ...recording from the air. Nothing out here. (clear) Matter of fact, this is the first one I've observed and I would say now it's 20,000 feet.

H: Uh huh.

END OF TAPE